

SOORARAI POTTRU
Suriya was pitch-perfect in this biopic of Air Deccan founder Captain Gorur Ramaswamy Iyengar Gopinath. Sudha Kongara Prasad, director of the Tamil drama, will helm the remake



REMADE IN HINDI

MILI
Father-daughter duo Boney Kapoor and Janhvi Kapoor come together for the first time for this survival thriller based on the Malayalam film, *Helen*

SHEHZADA
Kartik Aaryan has big shoes to fill as he features in this remake of Allu Arjun-starrer *Ala Vaikunthapurramuloo*, the Telugu hit that was one of the most watched films online during the first lockdown







ANGAMALY DIARIES
Abundantia Entertainment has acquired the rights to Lijo Jose Pellissery's vibrant Malayalam film about wayward youth, scrumptious food and crime in the Angamaly region of Kerala



HIT: THE FIRST CASE
Another Telugu film gets a makeover. This one's an action thriller with Rajkummar Rao and Sanya Malhotra

AYYAPPANUM KOSHIYUM
Biju Menon and Prithviraj were splendid in this Malayalam drama about a rivalry gone too far. Arjun Kapoor and John Abraham face the tall order of replicating their thespian masterclass.



sary for the South Indian original to have been a huge hit or for it to have had a big hero to spawn a Hindi adaptation". The story is more important.

SHAKING UP THE NORTH

Pushpa's success in single cinemas of tier II and III centres in northern theatrical markets illustrates that films from the South are gradually eating into the theatrical share of Hindi films. "Popularity and stardom of South Indian actors is no longer just a regional phenomenon," says Rathi. "As much as Allu Arjun's films have been popular, so have the films of Mahesh Babu, Ram Charan and Jr NTR. It is only a matter of time before others too decide to release them theatrically." Or they can choose to work with them like Bhushan Kumar, who is producing two films with Prabhas—*Radhe Shyam* and *Adipurush*. Southern stars are also keen to dub the Hindi versions themselves. Ram Charan and Jr NTR have done so for *RRR*, as have Prabhas and Yash for *Radhe Shyam* and *KGF 2*, respectively.

The rising clout of south side cinema has rattled some in Mumbai. Recently, when Manish Shah announced that he would release the Hindi dubbed version of Allu Arjun's 2020 hit *Ala Vaikunthapurramuloo* in cinemas, the makers of the Hindi version panicked. Titled *Shehzada*, the remake features Kartik Aaryan and Kriti Sanon and is expected to release later this year. Shah ultimately axed his plans after *Shehzada's* producers reportedly paid him a hefty sum to do so. He will now be releasing it on his channel Dhinchaak TV on February 13. Calling Kartik "insecure", Shah says: "Actors should have the confidence to pull it off. Picture *achchhi banaate toh affect nahin hota* [If they made a good film, it wouldn't affect collections]." Meanwhile, Shah is basking in his newfound success. He hasn't got the rights to *Pushpa - Chapter 2* yet. "When they come to me for *Pushpa 2*, I expect to close at a price that is workable for all," he says. "I am not here to lose money." He can afford to dictate terms. ■